

Porch → Mudroom Conversion

Enclose the bay beside the entrance stair · raise the floor 0.95 m · split into entry landing + fitted mudroom

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Orange (84100) · Vaucluse · France

July 2026 · Rev B

WHAT & WHY (REV B)

The covered, open-sided bay next to the entrance stair (today: bins, floor $\approx +0.30$ m) is enclosed with an insulated masonry wall and its floor raised ≈ 0.95 m to $+1.25$. Inside, it is split in two: a 2.0×1.4 m entry LANDING behind new glazed aluminium door K1 at the stair head (security + thermal buffer), and a 2.0×2.5 m fitted MUDROOM behind a light partition with timber door V — walking in, you face the mirror. Fit-out: wardrobes W1 (2 modules), bench B1 with hooks and lit niches, mirror unit M1, shoe tower. One Déclaration Préalable covers the works.

THE FOUR DECISIONS, ANSWERED

CIRCULATION & THE TWO DOORS

Stair → K1 → landing → V → mudroom. K1 opens INWARD onto the landing (hinge north — never out over the flight; self-closing). V opens INTO the mudroom (hinge west; leaf parks on W1's side panel). Old east door of earlier drafts: cancelled, wall built solid.

HOW TO RAISE THE FLOOR

Masonry sleeper walls + beam-and-block deck with a ventilated void (Option A) — the standard French method: no settlement, dry, self-build friendly. One level $+1.25$ across landing and mudroom — no step at V. Compacted fill + slab only with disciplined compaction.

PERMITS

A Déclaration Préalable (Cerfa 13703) is mandatory (new surface + façade change: wall, K1, glazing band, closed window). 1–2 months instruction; wait out the 2-month appeal window. Orange is a major heritage town — expect ABF interest; the design is styled to pass.

JOINERY — FRANCE vs TÜRKIYE

Turkish custom flat-pack lands at $\approx$ €5.0–7.5k vs €9–14k French bespoke ($\approx$ 40–45 % cheaper) under the EU–TR customs union (A.TR = 0 % duty; 20 % import VAT). Only with a trusted atelier, measured AFTER the shell. Fallback: FR semi-custom $\approx$ €3.5–6k.

HEADLINE NUMBERS (ORDER OF MAGNITUDE)

$\approx 8 \text{ m}^2$

enclosed: landing 2.8 + mudroom 5.0 m^2

+0.95 m

floor raise $+0.30 \rightarrow +1.25$

€8.4–13.7k

shell by artisan (€4.2–6.5k self-build materials)

€5.0–7.5k

TR joinery landed (vs €9–14k FR bespoke)

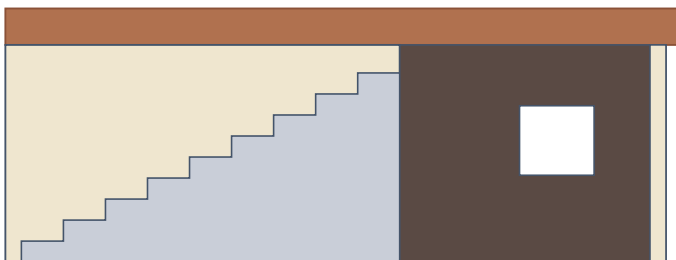
1–2 mo

DP instruction (2 mo if ABF)

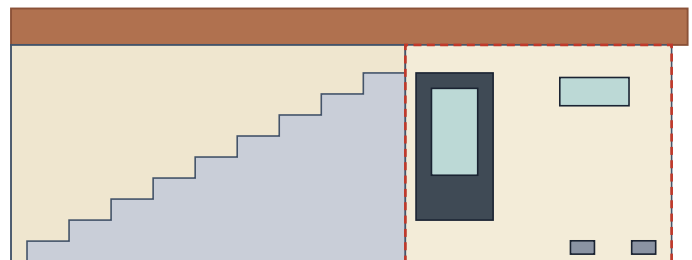
€360–540

taxe d'aménagement, one-off

THE ONLY EXTERNAL CHANGE



BEFORE — open bay (bins)



AFTER — rendered wall + glazed door K1 + high glazing band

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Money, permits and the five rules that keep a self-build out of trouble

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COST PICTURE — REV B QUANTITIES (REFINE WITH QUOTES)

Construction shell (≈ 8 m²)	Artisan	Self-build mat.
Footings · walls · render · infills	€3,500–5,500	€1,650–2,300
Floor raise (Opt. A) · partition · roof jct · ceiling	€2,100–3,400	€900–1,400
Electrics · doors K1 + V · glazing band · tiling	€2,800–4,800	€1,650–2,800
SHELL TOTAL	≈ €8.4–13.7k	≈ €4.2–6.5k incl. doors

Joinery route (W1 + B1 + M1 + tower)	Landed	Note
FR bespoke menuisier, installed	€9–14k	full warranty, zero logistics
FR semi-custom (PAX + fronts)	€3.5–6k	pragmatic middle, near-reference look
TR custom flat-pack shipped	€5.0–7.5k	0 % duty (A.TR) + 20 % VAT; measure after shell

All-in: ≈ €9.2–14k self-build + TR joinery · ≈ €17.4–27.7k artisan + FR bespoke. Add 10–15 % contingency.

PERMIT PATH — DÉCLARATION PRÉALABLE

- 1 Ask Mairie d'Orange (Service Urbanisme): PLU zone + ABF perimeter status.
- 2 File DP (Cerfa 13703): plans + section + façades before/after + photo-montage.
- 3 Instruction 1 month (2 in ABF zone; silence = approval). Display the site panel; let the 2-month appeal window pass.
- 4 Build to the approved file; declare completion (DAACT). Taxe d'aménagement ≈ €360–540 follows.

Sep · DP file

Oct–Nov · instruction

appeal window

shell 3–4 wks

fit-out 2–3 wks

≈ 5–6 months door-to-door — half of it is waiting for paperwork. Joinery is produced in parallel, installed last.

TOP 5 DO'S & DON'TS FOR THE SELF-BUILDER

DO

- DO get the PLU/ABF answer in writing before drawing the DP file.
- DO build Option A (ventilated beam-and-block) on DPC — dry floor forever.
- DO cast landing + mudroom at the same +1.25: zero step at door V.
- DO run electrics (sockets, sensor light, 24 V LED feed) before lining.
- DO re-measure everything after the shell and only then order joinery.

DON'T

- DON'T start any structural work before DP approval + appeal window.
- DON'T hang K1 opening outward over the stair — ever (inward, hinge north).
- DON'T hard-mortar the new wall to the roof timbers (compressible joint).
- DON'T order Turkish joinery or K1 from plan dimensions — only site measures.
- DON'T skip the vent grilles: an unventilated void = damp floor.

IF IT GOES WRONG — THE THREE REAL RISKS

- Measurement error kills the TR joinery route — iron rule: laser-measure after the shell, then issue the cut list and order. The landing depth (1.40 m) is an ASSUMPTION until measure day.
- ABF may impose render tint or door colour — routine in Orange; adjust and resubmit rather than fight it.
- Transit damage on the TR route — packing spec in the contract, photos before wrapping, insure landed value, note damage on the CMR at delivery.

NEXT: ① measure the bay, soffit & landing depth ② one email to the mairie (zone + ABF) ③ file the DP.

Full details, drawings and step-by-step method: see the A3 Design & Execution Pack (14 pages).